

Key:highway

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Main article: Highways

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Usage

Main article: Highways

The **highway** tag is the main tag used for identifying any kind of road, street or path. The highway type helps indicate the importance of the highway within the road network as a whole:

- **highway=motorway fast, restricted access road**
- **highway=trunk most important in standard road network**
- **highway=primary ...down to...**
- **highway=secondary ...**
- **highway=tertiary ...**
- **highway=unclassified least important in standard road network**
- **highway=residential** smaller road for access mostly to residential properties
- **highway=service** smaller road for access, often but not exclusively to non-residential properties

See Highway:International equivalence for how different countries apply these tags to their own road networks.

There are also values for paths and for special types of road.

Examples

See *highway examples*

Values

See below for details of commonly used tag values:

 highway



Description

The highway tag is the primary tag used for any kind of street or way.

Group: Highways

Used on these elements



Documented values: 382

Implies

- access=yes

Useful combination

- Access
- maxheight=*
- maxspeed=*
- maxweight=*
- oneway=*
- width=*

Status: Approved



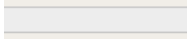
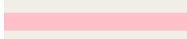
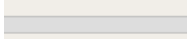
Tools for this tag

- taginfo (https://taginfo.openstreetmap.org/keys/highway), fr (http://taginfo.openstreetmap.fr/keys/highway), uk (http://taginfo.openstreetmap.org.uk/keys/highway), ie (http://taginfo.openstreetmap.ie/keys/highway), us (http://taginfo.openstreetmap.us/keys/highway)
- overpass-turbo (http://overpass-turbo.eu/?template=key&key=highway)

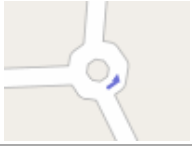
http://wiki.openstreetmap.org/wiki/Key:highway

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Key	Value	Element	Comment	Rendering	Photo
Roads					
These are the principal tags for the road network. They range from the most to least important.					
highway	motorway		A restricted access major divided highway, normally with 2 or more running lanes plus emergency hard shoulder. Equivalent to the Freeway, Autobahn, etc..		
highway	trunk		The most important roads in a country's system that aren't motorways. (Need not necessarily be a divided highway.)		
highway	primary		The next most important roads in a country's system. (Often link larger towns.)		
highway	secondary		The next most important roads in a country's system. (Often link towns.)		
highway	tertiary		The next most important roads in a country's system. (Often link smaller towns and villages)		
highway	unclassified		The least most important through roads in a country's system – i.e. minor roads of a lower classification than tertiary, but which serve a purpose other than access to properties. Often link villages and hamlets. (The word 'unclassified' is a historical artefact of the UK road system and does not mean that the classification is unknown; you can use highway=road for that.)		
highway	residential		Roads which serve as an access to housing, without function of connecting settlements. Often lined with housing.		
highway	service		For access roads to, or within an industrial estate, camp site, business park, car park etc. Can be used in conjunction with service=* to indicate the type of usage and with access=* to indicate who can use it and in what circumstances.		
Link roads					
highway	motorway_link		The link roads (sliproads/ramps) leading to/from a motorway from/to a motorway or lower class highway. Normally with the same motorway restrictions.		

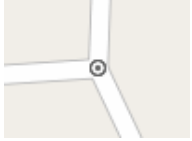
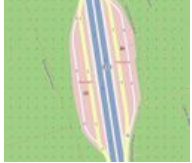
					
highway	trunk_link		The link roads (sliproads/ramps) leading to/from a trunk road from/to a trunk road or lower class highway.		
highway	primary_link		The link roads (sliproads/ramps) leading to/from a primary road from/to a primary road or lower class highway.		
highway	secondary_link		The link roads (sliproads/ramps) leading to/from a secondary road from/to a secondary road or lower class highway.	same rendering as highway=secondary in mapnik	
highway	tertiary_link		The link roads (sliproads/ramps) leading to/from a tertiary road from/to a tertiary road or lower class highway.	same rendering as highway=tertiary in mapnik	
Special road types					
highway	living_street		For living streets, which are residential streets where pedestrians have legal priority over cars, speeds are kept very low and where children are allowed to play on the street.		
highway	pedestrian	 	For roads used mainly/exclusively for pedestrians in shopping and some residential areas which may allow access by motorised vehicles only for very limited periods of the day. To create a 'square' or 'plaza' create a closed way and tag as pedestrian and also with area=yes.		
highway	track		Roads for mostly <i>agricultural or forestry uses</i> . To describe the quality of a track, see <i>tracktype=*</i> . Note: Although <i>tracks</i> are often rough with unpaved surfaces, this tag is not describing the quality of a road but its use. Consequently, if you want to tag a general use road, use one of the general <i>highway</i> values instead of <i>track</i> .		
highway	bus_guideway		A busway where the vehicle guided by the way (though not a railway) and is not suitable for other traffic. Please note: this is not a normal bus lane, use <i>access=no</i> , <i>psv=yes</i> instead!		
highway	raceway		A course or track for (motor) racing		
highway	road		A road where the mapper is unable to ascertain the classification from the information available. This is intended as a temporary tag to mark a road until it has been properly surveyed. Once it has been surveyed, the classification should be updated to the appropriate value.		
Paths					

highway	footway		For designated footpaths; i.e., mainly/exclusively for pedestrians. This includes walking tracks and gravel paths. If bicycles are allowed as well, you can indicate this by adding a bicycle=yes tag. Should not be used for paths where the primary or intended usage is unknown. Use highway=pedestrian for pedestrianised roads in shopping or residential areas and highway=track if it is usable by agricultural or similar vehicles.		
highway	bridleway		For horses. Equivalent to highway=path + horse=designated .		
highway	steps		For flights of steps (stairs) on footways. Use with step_count=* to indicate the number of steps		
highway	path		A non-specific path. Use highway=footway for paths mainly for walkers, highway=cycleway for one also usable by cyclists, highway=bridleway for ones available to horses as well as walkers and highway=track for ones which is passable by agriculture or similar vehicles.		
When sidewalk (or pavement) is tagged on the main roadway (see Sidewalks)					
sidewalk	both / left / right / no		Specifies that the highways has sidewalks on both sides, on one side or no sidewalk at all		
When cycleway is drawn as its own way (see Bicycle)					
highway	cycleway		For designated cycleways. Add foot=* only if default-access-restrictions do not apply.		
Cycleway tagged on the main roadway or lane (see Bicycle)					
cycleway	lane		A lane is a route that lies within the roadway		
cycleway	opposite		Used on ways with oneway=yes where it is legally permitted to cycle in both directions. Used together with oneway:bicycle=no .		
cycleway	opposite_lane		Used on ways with oneway=yes that have a cycling lane going the opposite direction of normal traffic flow (a "contraflow" lane). Used together with oneway:bicycle=no .		
cycleway	track		A track provides a route that is separated from traffic. In the United States, this term is often used to refer to bike lanes that are separated from lanes for cars by pavement buffers, bollards, parking lanes, and curbs. <i>Note</i> that a cycle track may alternatively be drawn as a separate way next to the road which is tagged as highway=cycleway .		
cycleway	opposite_track		Used on ways with oneway=yes that have a cycling track going the opposite direction of normal traffic flow		

cycleway	share_busway		There is a bus lane that cyclists are permitted to use.		
cycleway	shared_lane		Cyclists share a lane with motor vehicles, but there are markings indicating that they should share the lane with motorists.		
busway	lane		Bus lane on both sides of the road.		
Lifecycle					
highway	proposed		For planned roads, use with proposed=* and also proposed=* with a value of the proposed highway value.		
highway	construction		For roads under construction. Use construction=* to hold the value for the completed road.		
Attributes					
abutters	commercial/ industrial/ mixed/ residential/ retail etc.		See Key:abutters for more details.		
bicycle_road	yes		A bicycle road is a road designated for bicycles. If residential streets get the status of bicycle roads, normally, by special signs, motor traffic is admitted with limited speed, often only for residents.		
driving_side	left/ right	 	Defines which side of the road vehicles must legally use. (must only be used on highways when they are an exception to the rule)		
ford	yes	 	The road crosses through stream or river, vehicles must enter any water.		
ice_road	yes		A highway is laid upon frozen water basin, definitely doesn't exist in summer.		
incline	Number %/°	 	Incline steepness as percents ("5%") or degrees ("20°"). Positive/negative values indicate movement upward/downwards in the direction of the way.		
junction	roundabout	 	This automatically implies oneway=yes , the oneway direction is defined by the sequential ordering of nodes within the Way. This applies on a way, tagged with highway=* already.		
lanes	number		The number of traffic lanes for general purpose traffic, also for buses and other specific classes of vehicle.		
lit	yes/no	 	Street lighting		

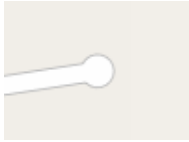
motorroad	yes / no		The motorroad tag is used to describe highways that have motorway-like access restrictions but that are not a motorway.		
mountain_pass	yes		The highest point of a mountain pass.		
mtb:scale	0-6		Applies to highway=path and highway=track . A classification scheme for mtb trails (few inclination and downhill).		
mtb:scale:uphill	0-5		A classification scheme for mtb trails for going uphill if there is significant inclination.		
mtb:scale:imba	0-4		The IMBA Trail Difficulty Rating System shall be used for bikeparks. It is adapted to mtb trails with artificial obstacles.		
mtb:description	Text		Applies to highway=path and highway=track . A key to input variable infos related to mtbiking on a way with human words		
overtaking	yes/ no/ both/ forward/ backward		Specifying sections of roads where overtaking is legally forbidden.		
parking:condition	free/ ticket/ disc/ residents/ customers/ private		Specifying the parking conditions (terms). See parking:condition=* for more details.		
parking:lane	parallel/ diagonal/ perpendicular/ marked/ no_parking/ no_stopping/ fire_lane.		Specifying the parking space. See parking:lane=* for more details.		
passing_places	yes		A way which has frequent passing places		
sac_scale	hiking / mountain_hiking / demanding_mountain_hiking / alpine_hiking / demanding_alpine_hiking / difficult_alpine_hiking		Applies to highway=path and highway=footway . A classification scheme for hiking trails.		
service	alley/ driveway/ parking_aisle etc.		See Key:service for more details.		
surface	paved / unpaved / asphalt / concrete / paving_stones / cobblestone / metal / wood / grass_paver / gravel / pebblestone / grass / ground / earth / dirt / mud / sand		See Key:surface for more details.		
tactile_paving	yes / no		A paving in the ground to be followed with a blindman's stick.	Not to be rendered on standard maps.	
tracktype	grade1/ grade2/ grade3/ grade4/ grade5		To describe the quality of the surface. See Key:tracktype for more information.		
traffic_calming	yes/ bump/ hump/ cushion/ table etc.		See Key:traffic calming for more details.		
trail_visibility	excellent / good / intermediate / bad / horrible / no		Applies to highway=path , highway=footway , highway=cycleway and highway=bridleway . A classification for hiking trails visibility		
winter_road	yes		A highway functions during winter, probably can't be driven in summer.		

Other highway features

highway	bus_stop		A small bus stop. Can be mapped more rigorously using <code>public_transport=stop_position</code> for the position where the vehicle stops and <code>public_transport=platform</code> for the place where passengers wait. See <code>public_transport=*</code> for more details.		
highway	crossing		Pedestrians can cross a street here; e.g., zebra crossing		
highway	elevator		Elevator		
highway	emergency_access_point		Sign number which can be used to define your current position in case of an emergency. Use with <code>ref=NUMBER_ON_THE_SIGN</code>		
highway	escape		Emergency lane beside long descending slopes for trucks and other vehicles to stop safely after brake failure. In the USA this is called a "runaway truck" lane or ramp.		
highway	give_way		A "give way," or "Yield" sign		
emergency	phone		A calling device can be used to tell on your current position in case of an emergency. Use with <code>ref=NUMBER_ON_THE_SIGN</code>		
highway	mini_roundabout		Similar to roundabouts, but at the center there is either a painted circle or a fully traversable island. In case of an untraversable center island, <code>junction=roundabout</code> should be used. Rendered as anti-clockwise by default <code>direction=anticlockwise</code> . To render clockwise add the tag <code>direction=clockwise</code> .		
highway	motorway_junction		Indicates a junction (UK) or exit (US). <code>ref=*</code> should be set to the exit number or junction identifier. (Some roads – e.g., the A14 – also carry junction numbers, so the tag may be encountered elsewhere despite its name)		
highway	passing_place		The location of a passing space		
highway	rest_area	 	Place where drivers can leave the road to rest, but not refuel.		
highway	speed_camera		A fixed road-side or overhead speed camera.		

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highway	street_lamp		A street light, lamppost, street lamp, light standard, or lamp standard is a raised source of light on the edge of a road, which is turned on or lit at a certain time every night	
highway	services		A service station to get food and eat something, often found at motorways	 
highway	stop		A stop sign	
highway	traffic_signals		Lights that control the traffic	 
highway	turning_circle		A turning circle is a rounded, widened area usually, but not necessarily, at the end of a road to facilitate easier turning of a vehicle. Also known as a <i>cul de sac</i> .	 
highway	User Defined		<i>All commonly used values</i> (https://taginfo.openstreetmap.org/keys/highway#values) according to Taginfo	

Assumptions

Only highway=motorway/motorway_link implies anything about quality. Other road types, from highway=trunk through highway=tertiary to highway=residential=residential/service or highway=path/footway/cycleway/track do not imply anything about road quality. In area with poor infrastructure road forming main road network, of the highest importance in region should be tagged highway=trunk - no matter whether it is high-quality wide asphalt road or narrow low-quality tract worse than highway=service in other regions. Some primary roads in Africa are unpaved.

In absence of surface, tracktype and other tags describing quality of road one may try to extrapolate this information from value of highway tag. Note that this needs tuning for every region. Typical highway=primary may be drastically different in various places across the planet.

It is highly recommended to add and use tags describing road quality like surface. In one region it may be obvious that all highway=tertiary are paved and highway=track unpaved but no assumption like that will work worldwide.

See also

Highways	
Roads	motorway, trunk, primary, secondary, tertiary, unclassified, residential, service
Link Roads	motorway_link, trunk_link, primary_link, secondary_link, motorway_junction
Special	living street, pedestrian, bicycle road, track, bus guideway, raceway, road, construction, escape
Paths	footway, cycleway, foot+bicycle, bridleway, steps, escalator, path
Sidewalks	sidewalk, cycleway lane, cycleway tracks, bus and cyclists, lanes:psv, busway
Lanes	number of lanes, Direction instructions per lane, signposts
See also	Conditional restrictions, turn restrictions, Highway tagging samples

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